AD R. D. FLORIANUM LA VALLEE, ANTISTITEM URBANUM, RECTOREM ATHE- NAEI CATHOLICI LUGDUNENSIS: QUINQUAGESIMO EXEUNTE ANNO AB ATHENAEO CONDITO.

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D i l e c t e fili, s a l u t e m e t a p o s t o l i c a m b e n e d i c t i o n e m . — L u g d u n e n s e m i s t a m C a t h o l i c a m s t u d i o r u m U n i v e r s i t a t e m i u c u n d e a c c e p i m u s i n e o esse, u t q u i n q u a g e s i m u m n a t a l e m s u u m , qui dies erit q u a r t u s p r o x i m i m e n s i s , feliciter a g a t . E t e n i m , s t a t i m ac l e x illa a p u d v o s l a t a est, catholicis e Gallia profecto e x s p e c t a t i s s i m a , q u a c a v e b a t u r ut altiores disciplinae libere tradi p o s s e n t , E p i s c o p i i s t a r u m r e g i o n u m , q u a e inter m e r i d i e m solisque o r t u m s p e c t a n t , o p p o r t u n o sane consilio, a d s t u d i a o p t i m a r u m a r t i u m a l e n d a t u e n d a m q u e u n o t e m p o r e fi d e i i n t e g r i t a t e m , M a g n u m i n urbe i s t a Lyceum, alia p o s t a l i a m disciplina i n d u c t a , condere properarunt. I n q u o q u i d e m nobilissimo sacrae p r o f a n a e q u e doctrinae domicilio, u t p o t e q u o d

t o t irdustribus magistris, i i s d e m q u e o b p l u r i m a e d i t a m a g n i q u e m o m e n t i v o l u m i n a d e a n i m o r u m c u l t u egregie meritis, a n t e h a c fl o r u e r i t h o d i e q u e floreat, mirari n o n licet si clerici ac sacerdotes, e dioecesibus Galliae et v e l e x t e r a r u m n a t i o n u m i s t u c confluentes, t a m s o l i d a m c o p i o s a m q u e rerum c o g n i t i o n e m sibi c o m p a r a v e r u n t , e t t a m r e c t e i u v e n e s laici a d christia- n a e sapientiae principia e t a d liberales artes conformati sunt. U n d e f a c t u m e s t - q u o d fieri necesse erat - ut clerus, q u e m v o s e x c o l u i s t i s , ad a l u m n o s S e m i n a r i o r u m r e g u n d o s a t q u e erudiendos, i t e m q u e a d sacri ministerii exer- c i t a t i o n e m , se m u l t o p a r a t i o r e m i n s t r u c t i o r e m q u e contulerit, et laici h o m i - n e s e p a l a e s t r a i s t a a d d o c e n d u m , a d i u s d i c e n d u m p e t e n d u m v e , a d civi- l i u m q u o r u m l i b e t officiorum p e r f u n c t i o n e m i d o n e i p r o b a t i q u e , c u m decore catholici n o m i n i s , accesserint e t rehgionis c a u s a m , o p p o r t u n i t a t e data, susceperint s t r e n u e q u e egerint. A t e a q u o q u e laus A t h e n a e i v e s t r i m a g i - stris m e r i t o tribuitur, q u o d , h o c diuturno t e m p o r i s spatio, nihil q u i c q u a m a u t docuerint a u t t y p i s exscripserint, q u o d c a t h o l i c a e doctrinae r e p u g n a - ret e t i n r e p r e h e n s i o n e m incurreret; i i d e m praeterea t a l e m p r a e s t a n t absti- n e n t i a m n o b i h t a t e m q u e animi, u t e x i g u a a d m o d u m laboris sui m e r c e d e c o n t e n t i sint. H a e c igitur t a n t a a b A t h e n a e o c o n l a t a in E c c l e s i a m e t i n Galliam beneficia, t a m q u e praeclara e o r u m , qui i b i d e m d o c u e r u n t v e l a d h u c d o c e n t , promerita, quemadmodum Nosmet, D e o a g e n t e s gratias v o b i s q u e o m n i b u s g r a t u l a n t e s , recolimus, i t a v o s decet, per h a n c quinqua- gesimi natalis faustitatem, Lugduni commemorare sollemniter. Quae q u i d e m sollemnis c o m m e m o r a t i o id q u o q u e utilitatis latura est, u t fi d e l e s r e g i o n u m i s t a r u m intellegant, q u a m uberes a d h u n c d i e m liberalitatem s u a m c o n s e c u t i sint fructus e t q u a n t u m sibi, u t A t h e n a e u m amplificetur ac m a g i s in dies floreat, supersit a g e n d u m . Coeptis interea vestris obse- c u n d e t d i v i n a m q u e o p e m conciliet a p o s t o l i c a b e n e d i c t i o , q u a m , p a t e r n a e caritatis N o s t r a e t e s t e m , tibi, dilecte fili, et A t h e n a e i doctoribus auditori- busque peramanter in Domino impertimus. D a t u m R o m a e a p u d S a n c t u m P e t r u m , die x v i m e n s i s octobris, a n n o sacro MDCCCCXXV, Pontificatus N o s t r i quarto.

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